

Sluicing Is not Stripping in Turkish: A Reply to Hankamer (2012)

0. Purpose

To provide evidence that elliptical structures with the wh-phrase remnant in Turkish are Sluicing structures derived via Movement + Elide (a la Ince (2009, 2004/2012), but not Stripping (Hankamer (2012))).

by providing further evidence that Sluicing in Turkish

- (i) is not local,
- (ii) is island-insensitive and unbounded, and
- (iii) can go backward.

1. Hankamer (2012)

Claim: No sluicing in Turkish

Key properties of sluicing:

- a. always strands a wh-phrase (ex. 1)
 - b. is unbounded and insensitive to islands (ex. 2a, b & c)
 - c. can go backward (ex. 3)
-
- 1. Harvey wants to buy some kind of car, and I sure wish I knew what kind of car.
 - 2. a. The Complex NP Constraint
(??) I believe the claim that he bit someone, but they don't know who.
b. The Sentential Subject Constraint
(??) That he'll hire someone is possible, but I won't divulge who.

c. . . . and I would be eternally grateful if you would find me a detective who could find out what kind.

3. Although I have no idea what kind, I'm sure Harvey bought a car.

Hankamer states that no basic properties of sluicing holds in Turkish:

- A. Not only wh-phrases but also non-wh-phrases as remnant:

4. Hasan okul-a gid-ecek-ti , ama git-ti mi bilmiyorum.
school-dat go-fut-pst but go-pst Q I-don't-know
'Hasan was going to go to school, but I don't know whether he went.'
5. Hasan bir yer-e git-ti , ama okul-a mı bilmiyorum.
a school-dat go-pst but school-dat Q I-don't-know
'Hasan went somewhere, but I don't know whether it was to school.'

- B. Sluicing is not unbounded:

6. *Hasan bir yer-e gitti , ve Ayşe-nin nere-ye bildiğini sanıyoruz.
a place-dat went and gen where knows we.think
'Hasan went somewhere, and we think Ayşe knows where.'

- C. No backward sluicing:

7. Kim-i *(gördüğünü) bil-me-diğ-im halde , Hasan-ın
who-acc he-saw know-neg-prt-agr although -gen
biri-ni gördüğünden eminim.
someone saw I'm-sure
'Although I don't know who, I am sure Hasan saw someone.'

¹ Hankamer does not provide any example to show that sluicing is island-insensitive. For this reason, I added ex. 2a-b.

Hankamer's conclusion: These are **stripping** structures.

2. Counter-evidence

- All key properties of sluicing hold in Turkish
 - Sluicing is not local
 - Sluicing is island-insensitive and unbounded
 - Sluicing is backward

2.1. *Sluicing is not local in Turkish*

Hankamer claims:

- since a pause occurs between the sluiced wh-phrase and the following matrix verb,
- the sluiced wh-phrase is not part of a complement clause for which the matrix verb subcategorizes
- rather, the wh-phrase and the verb following it are two independent sentences

8. Hasan biri-ni görmüş, ama kim-i bilmiyorum.
 someone-acc saw but who-acc I-don't know
 "Hasan saw someone, but I don't know who."

-8 represented as follows under his analysis:

9. . . . [_{S1} Kimi?]₁ & [_{S2} *pro*_{SUB} *pro*₁ bilmiyorum]

-Three arguments against (9):

(i) A speaker-oriented adverb such as *ne yazık ki* ‘unfortunately’ can precede a sluiced wh-phrase:

10. Hasan birin-den borç almış; **ne yazık ki** kim-den bil-m-iyor-uz.
one-abl debt took unfortunately who-abl not.knowing
‘Hasan borrowed money from someone; unfortunately we don’t know from who.’

-The wh-phrase in (10) is part of the complement of a higher clause since *ne yazık ki* ‘unfortunately’ cannot modify an interrogative sentence (ex. 11a) but only a declarative sentence (ex. 11b-c):

11. a. *Ne yazık ki , Ecem kim-le oyn-uyor?
unfortunately who-comm playing
‘*Unfortunately, who is Ecem playing with?’
b. Ne yazık ki Ecem-in kim-le oynadığını bil-m-iyor-uz.
unfortunately -gen who-comm played not.knowing
‘Unfortunately, we don’t know who Ecem is playing with.’
c. Ne yazık ki bu soru-nun cevap-ın-ı bil-m-iyor-uz.
unfortunately this question-gen answer not.knowing
‘Unfortunately, we don’t know the answer to this question.’

-Therefore, the sluiced wh-phrase is part of the (elided) complement of the matrix verb in (10).

(ii) *Acaba* ‘I.wonder’ cannot precede a sluiced wh-phrase in examples similar to (8):

12. Hasan birin-den borç almış; (***acaba**) kim-den bil-m-iyor-uz.
one-abl debt took I.wonder who-abl not.knowing
‘Hasan borrowed money from someone; we don’t know (*we wonder) from who.’

-However, *acaba* can modify a non-elided wh-question as well as a matrix sluicing structure (13):

13. A: Tolga biri-yle konuşuyor.
 someone-comm talking
 “Tolga is talking to someone.”
B: Acaba kim-le (konuşuyor)?
 I.wonder who-comm talking
 “I wonder who he is talking with?”

-Under Hankamer’s analysis, *acaba* would be expected to occur with a sluiced wh-phrase since the wh-phrase is considered an independent element as in (13). So, his analysis cannot predict the non-occurrence of *acaba* in (12).

-*acaba* is a speaker-oriented adverb and can occur only in matrix clauses. (12) shows that *acaba* is inside a complement clause that includes the adverb itself and the sluiced wh-phrase.

-Likewise, *acaba* is ungrammatical in the unelided version of (12):

14. Hasan birin-den borç almış; (***acaba**) kim-den al-dı-ğ-ın-ı bil-m-iyor-uz.
 one-abl debt took I.wonder who-abl took not.knowing
 ‘Hasan borrowed money from someone; we don’t know (*we wonder) from who he borrowed money.’

-Under the analysis that the sluiced wh-phrase is part of an elided complement clause in (12) predicts why *acaba* cannot occur.

(iii) *Ama* ‘but’ (with its counter-expectational function) can precede a sluiced wh-phrase in structures similar to (8):

15. Hasan biri-ni görmüş, **ama** kim-i bilmiyorum.
 someone-acc saw but who-acc I-don't know
 "Hasan saw someone, but I don't know who."

- Under Hankamer's analysis, *ama* would coordinate the antecedent clause and (the elided clause that contains) the sluiced wh-phrase.

-However, *ama* cannot coordinate a non-interrogative sentence with an interrogative sentence (at least, with its counter-expectational function) (16):

16. *Hasan birin-i gör-müş; ama kimi gör-müş?
 one-acc saw but who-acc saw
 '*Hasan saw someone; but who did he see?'

-It does coordinate two non-interrogative sentences (17a & b):

17. a. Tolga Ecem-i gör-müş; ama biz gör-me-dik.
 -acc saw but we not.saw
 'Tolga saw Ecem, but we didn't.'
 b. Tolga Ecem-i gör-müş; ama biz (bun-u) bil-m-iyor-du-k.
 -acc saw but we this-acc not.knew
 'Tolga saw Ecem, but we didn't know it.'

-Therefore, *ama* coordinates the antecedent clause with the '... bilmiyorum' clause in (18):

18. [Hasan birini görmüş]; ama [kimi bilmiyorum]
 one-acc saw but who-acc I-don't-know
 '*Hasan saw someone; but I don't know who.'

-Under Hankamer's analysis, coordination would need to be discontinuous for the antecedent clause and the independent *bilmiyorum* clause to be conjoined:

19. [Hasan birini görmüş]; [kimi] [bilmiyorum]



ama

- No such discontinuous coordination possible

-To sum, sluicing in Turkish is **NOT** local

2.2. Island-Insensitivity & Unboundedness

-Sluicing is also island-insensitive in Turkish as its counterpart in English is:

20. A: Ahmet [**arkadaş-lar-ın-dan** **bir-in-in** bak-tığı] bi(r) köpeğ-i
 friend-PLU-3SPOSS-ABL one-POSS-GEN look.after-NSR one dog-ACC
 tedavi ediyor.
 treatment doing
 'Ahmet is treating a dog that one of his friends takes care of.'

B: Hangi arkadaş-ın-ın ?
 which friend-3SPOSS-GEN
 'Which friend of his?'

(İnce 2009: 56)

21. A: Ali [**bir dizi** **film-i** izleyince] duygulandı?
 one series movie-ACC watch.when felt.emotional
 'Ali felt emotional when he watched a TV show.'

B: Hangi dizi film-i?
which series movie-ACC
'Which TV show?'

(İnce 2009: 60)

-If sluicing were not unbounded in Turkish (6), (17) would be ungrammatical:

6. *Hasan bir yer-e gitti , ve Ayşe-nin nere-ye bildiğini sanıyoruz.
a place-dat went and gen where knows we.think
'Hasan went somewhere, and we think Ayşe knows where.'

- (6) could be ungrammatical due to some constraint in syntax-phonology interface
- Göksel (2013) is promising in this regard

2.3. Backward Sluicing

-Sluicing in Turkish can also go backward, as Sluicing in English can:

22. a. Ayşe tam olarak kim-den bil-m-iyor , ama bugün birin-den
exactly who-abl not.knowing but today one-abl
çok güzel bir hediye almış.
very nice a gift took
'Ayşe doesn't know exactly from who, but she received a very nice gift from
someone.'

b. Kim-le bil-me-se-m de , Ayşe-nin biri-yle görüştüğünü
who-comm not.knowing though -gen one-comm sees
bil-iyor-um.
knowing
'Even though I do not know with who, I know that Ayşe sees someone.'

3. Pseudo-Sluicing and Other Issues

İnce (2006): a sluiced wh-phrase with an overt Tense marker analyzed as 'pseudo-sluicing':

23. Hasan birin-e kitap ver-miş, ama kim-e-y-di bil-m-iyor-um.
one-dat book gave but who-dat-cop-pst not.knowing
'Hasan gave a book to someone, but I don't know who it was.'

- A different derivation than Sluicing structures

-Hankamer (2012): Accusative Case is illicit on the remnant wh-phrase in pseudo-sluicing:

24. *Hasan birin-i görmüş, ama kim-i-y-di bil-m-iyor-um.
one-acc saw but who-acc-cop-pst not.knowing
'Hasan saw someone, but I don't know who it was.'

-However, it is MUCH BETTER with complex wh-phrases:

25. ?Hasan bir öğrenci-yi gör-müş, ama hangi öğrenci-yi-y-di
a student-acc saw but which student-acc-cop-pst
bil-m-iyor-um.
not.knowing
'Hasan saw a student, but we don't know which student he was.'

-At worst, the Case restriction in example (24) could be a matter of haplology.

-Hankamer: non-wh-phrases in the sluicing remnant

26. Hasan okul-a gid-ecek-ti, ama git-ti mi bilmiyorum.
school-dat go-fut-pst but go-pst Q I-don't-know
'Hasan was going to go to school, but I don't know whether he went.'

27. Hasan bir yer-e git-ti , ama okul-a mı bilmiyorum.
a school-dat go-pst but school-dat Q I-don't-know
'Hasan went somewhere, but I don't know whether it was to school.'

-(26) more likely to be full sentence with pro's:

26'. Hasan₁ okul-a₂ gidecekti, ama *pro*₁ *pro*₂ gitti mi bilmiyorum.

-In 27, *okula mı* not complement to *bilmiyorum*:

-*ne yazık ki* cannot precede *okula mı* (27')

27'. ... (**ne yazık ki*) *okula mı* bilmiyorum.

-*acaba* can precede it:

27''... *acaba okula mı* bilmiyorum.

-We saw that sluiced wh-phrases occur in complement clauses

- *Okula mı* cannot occur in a complement clause in (27)

-cf. English:

28. A: John went to school.

B: To school?/Where?

-English has the same property:

-Either both structures are not sluicing in both languages

-Or non-wh-remnants have different derivations in both languages

Sluicing-in-situ?

- Şener (2013): no overt wh-movement in sluicing in Turkish:

29. A: Pelin birisin-e ders ver-iyor.

P-nom someone-dat lesson give-pres

'Pelin tutors someone privately.'

B: Kim-e?

who-dat

'To whom?'

[_{IP=A} *pro* [_{XP} kim-e] ~~ders~~ — ~~ver-iyor~~]

who-dat lesson give-pres

-problem: Beck Effects

30. a. *Kimse kimi görmedi?
 anyone who-Acc see-Neg-Past?
 b. Kimi kimse görmedi?
 who-Acc anyone see-Neg-Past
 'Whom did nobody see?'

(Beck 1996)

-Overt movement of a wh-phrase over NPI/[+focus] element ameliorates these LF intervention effects.

-Sluicing is licit in such LF intervention effects:

31. a. A: Kimse belli bir kitab-ı oku-ma-dı.
 noone certain a book-acc read-neg-pst

'Noone read a certain book.'

B: Hangi kitab-ı?

which book-acc

'Which book?'

b. *Kimse hangi kitabı okumadı?

-Under Movement + Deletion, *hangi kitabı* moves overtly the intervening NPI; hence, grammatical:

32. [Hangi kitabı]₁ kimse ~~_____~~₁ okumadı?

-In-situ analysis cannot predict this since the wh-phrase is c-commanded by the NPI:

(C-COMMANDS = >; *kimse* > *hangi kitabı*)

33. ~~Kimse~~ [hangi kitabı] okumadı?²

5. Conclusion

-Elliptical structures with a wh-remnant are Sluicing structures in Turkish.

Big picture:

-English-centric approach misses typological diversity

-If a construction in language A does not have all the properties of the same construction in English,

² Notice that *pro* cannot replace *kimse*:

A: Kimse belli bir kitab-ı oku-ma-dı.
noone certain a book-acc read-neg-pst
'Noone read a certain book.'

B: **pro*/✓kimse hangi kitabı okumadı?
noone which book-acc read-neg-pst
'Which book did noone read?'

- we cannot conclude that language A lacks that construction
- it might arise from interfering factors in language A
- a fine-grained typological view required, already proposed by Craenenbroeck and Liptak (2006)

References

- Beck, Sigrid (1996). Wh-constructions and Transparent Logical Form. PhD dissertation, Universität Tübingen. Available at <http://www.sfs.uni-tuebingen.de>
- Craenenbroeck, Jeroen van and Anikó Lipták. 2006. "The cross-linguistic syntax of sluicing: evidence from Hungarian relatives," *Syntax* 9: 248-274.
- Hankamer, Jorge. 2012. Pseudo-Sluicing in Turkish. Handout. ICTL XVI. Ankara, Turkey.
- Göksel, Aslı. 2013. "Flexible word order and anchors of the clause," in *SOAS Working Papers in Linguistics*, Vol 16.
- İnce, Atakan. 2006. "Pseudo-sluicing in Turkish," in N. Kazanina, U. Minai, P.J. Monahan and H.L. Taylor (eds.), *University of Maryland Department of Linguistics Working Papers in Linguistics (UMWPiL)*, Volume XIV, pp. 111-126.
- İnce, Atakan. 2009. *Dimensions of Ellipsis: Investigations in Turkish*. Unpublished Ph.D. Dissertation. Department of Linguistics. University of Maryland, College Park.
- İnce, Atakan. 2012. "Sluicing in Turkish," in Jason Merchant & A. Simpson (eds.), *Sluicing: Cross-Linguistic Perspectives*, 248-269. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Şener, Serkan. 2013. “‘Sluicing’ without movement,” in U. Özge (ed.), *Proceedings of the 8th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics (WAFL 8)*, MIT Working Papers in Linguistics, Volume 67, pp. 311-324.